Weak Jump Shifts

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A weak jump shift is a jump response to an opening bid of 1♣, 1♦, 1♥, or 1♠. A jump to a new suit at the 2-level (e.g. 1♣ : 2♥) usually shows 2-5 HCP and a 6-card suit. At the 3-level (e.g. 1♥ : 3♣), it typically shows 2-7 HCP and a 7-card suit.

Weak jump shifts are, of course, more preemptive than the traditional strong jump shift that promises 17-19 points. The purported benefits of weak jump shifts are:

1. They occur more frequently than 17-19 point hands, and
2. Strong jump shifts gobble up valuable slam exploration space. If playing weak jump shifts, then 17-19 point suit-oriented hands get absorbed into natural 1- and 2-level responses (e.g. 1♥ : 2♣). However, this obviously adds extra meaning and burden to those bids.

An example of a weak jump shift:

Opener	Responder
♠92	♠AT8765
♥AKJ32	♥6
♦JT42	♦865
♣AT	♣532

Opener	Responder
1♥	2♠ (1)
Pass	

1. Weak jump shift

Opener's Rebids

Opener usually passes unless holding a strong hand and/or good support for partner.

Opener's Rebids	Meaning
Pass	Could be a strong hand with a misfit.
Rebidding his own suit	At least a 7-card suit. Non-forcing.
Raising partner's suit	Any single, double (or even triple) raise is natural and non-forcing. Responder is not expected to bid again.
Any new suit	Natural, promising extra strength and usually at least a 5+ card suit. Responder is allowed to pass, raise, or correct to opener's original suit. Responder should not make the mistake of rebidding his own suit.
2NT	A forcing game try, implying at least doubleton support for responder's suit. This is similar to a forcing 2NT response to an opening weak two bid. Responder must rebid his suit with a minimum. Bidding any other suit shows a maximum hand cooperating with opener's game try.

Examples

Opener	Responder
♠AKQ42	♠5
♥J92	♥73
♦5	♦KQT8642
♣KJ32	♣T84

Opener	Responder
1♠	3♦ (1)
Pass	

1. Weak jump shift

Opener	Responder
♠AQ32	♠654
♥A43	♥QJT765
♦J	♦86
♣A9875	♣63

Opener	Responder
1♣	2♥ (1)
2NT (2)	3♥ (3)
Pass	

1. Weak jump shift
2. Artificial, forcing game try
3. Signoff

Opener	Responder
♠KQ42	♠AT8765
♥AKJ32	♥6
♦K2	♦865
♣A9	♣532

Opener	Responder
1♥	2♠ (1)
4♠ (2)	Pass

1. Weak jump shift
2. Opener bids game with a massive supporting hand

Other Considerations

- After a 1♥/♠ opening, weak jump shifts should be avoided if responder has the strength to make a raise. Raising partner's major suit takes priority.
- Weak jump shifts are on in competition.
- Pairs who employ Bergen raises cannot use weak jump shifts after a 1♥/♠ opening.
- Pairs who use splinter bids should agree when a double-jump bid is a weak jump shift or a splinter. This particularly holds true in competitive auctions, e.g.

West	North	East	South
Pass	1♥	2♦	3♠

In this auction, 3♠ could show a weak hand with 7 spades... or it could be a spade void with heart support. Needless to say, a misunderstanding invites catastrophe.

See also

- Intermediate Jump Overcalls
  Constructive jump overcalls that show a long suit and 11-15 points.
- Soloway Jump Shifts
  A strong jump response with multiple possible meanings.
- Strong Jump Shifts
  A strong jump response to a 1-level opening bid.
- Weak Jump Overcalls
  Weak jump overcalls that show a long suit and 5-10 points.
- Weak Two Bid
  An opening 2-bid that shows a weak, single-suited hand.

